Elevate
QUALITY COMPLIANCE SOLUTIONS

ST-DLV-004

Startup Risk Register

Aligned with applicable standards and best practices | Version 1.0 | Elevate Quality Compliance Solutions LLC

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SAMPLE TEMPLATE — elevateqcs.com
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1 Purpose & Risk Management Framework

This Startup Risk Register is a living document for identifying, assessing, tracking, and managing risks across your business. Update it at least quarterly — or whenever a significant change occurs in your business environment, team, product, or market.

HOW TO USE: *SCORING: Likelihood (1=Rare, 2=Unlikely, 3=Possible, 4=Likely, 5=Almost Certain) × Impact (1=Negligible, 2=Minor, 3=Moderate, 4=Major, 5=Critical). Score 15–25 = HIGH (red), 8–14 = MEDIUM (amber), 1–7 = LOW (green). Add your own risks and remove placeholder rows before distributing.*

2 Company & Register Details

Company Name	Register Owner	Last Review Date
Enter company name	*Enter name / title*	*MM/DD/YYYY*

3 Risk Scoring Matrix

L \ I →	Impact 1 Negligible	Impact 2 Minor	Impact 3 Moderate	Impact 4 Major	Impact 5 Critical
5 Almost Certain	5	10	15	20	25
4 Likely	4	8	12	16	20
3 Possible	3	6	9	12	15
2 Unlikely	2	4	6	8	10
1 Rare	1	2	3	4	5

4 Risk Register

ID	Risk Title	Category	L (1-5)	I (1-5)	Score	Controls / Mitigations	Owner	Status	Review Date
STRATEGIC RISKS									
SR-001	**Failure to achieve product-market fit before runway depletes**	Strategic	4	5	20 HIGH	Rapid MVP iteration; monthly pivot reviews; investor dashboard	CEO	OPEN	*Q2 2026*
SR-002	**Key co-founder or CTO departure**	Strategic	3	5	15 HIGH	Vesting schedules; succession plan; documented IP ownership	CEO/Legal	MONITORING	*Q2 2026*

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ID	Risk Title	Category	L (1-5)	I (1-5)	Score	Controls / Mitigations	Owner	Status	Review Date
SR-003	**Competitor launches similar product at lower price**	Strategic	3	4	12 MEDIUM	Differentiation roadmap; patent filing review; pricing strategy	CEO	OPEN	*Q2 2026*
SR-004	*[Enter strategic risk]*	*Strategic*	—	—	—	*[Describe controls]*	*[Owner]*	OPEN	
FINANCIAL RISKS									
FR-001	**Cash runway falls below 6 months without new funding**	Financial	3	5	15 HIGH	Monthly burn rate review; bridge loan facility; investor updates	CFO/CEO	OPEN	*Q1 2026*
FR-002	**Key customer non-payment or churn reducing MRR significantly**	Financial	3	4	12 MEDIUM	Net payment terms; collections policy; ARR diversification	CFO	MONITORING	*Q1 2026*
FR-003	**Unexpected tax liability or regulatory fine**	Financial	2	3	6 LOW	Quarterly tax review; external accountant engaged	CFO	MITIGATED	*Q2 2026*
FR-004	*[Enter financial risk]*	*Financial*	—	—	—	*[Describe controls]*	*[Owner]*	OPEN	
OPERATIONAL RISKS									
OR-001	**Critical system outage or data loss event**	Operational	2	5	10 MEDIUM	Cloud backup; disaster recovery plan; SLA monitoring	CTO	MONITORING	*Q1 2026*
OR-002	**Key employee resigns with no documented handover**	Operational	4	4	16 HIGH	SOPs documented; cross-training; knowledge management SOP	COO	OPEN	*Q1 2026*
OR-003	**Third-party vendor / supplier failure**	Operational	2	3	6 LOW	Dual vendor strategy; vendor assessments; contract review	COO	MONITORING	*Q2 2026*
OR-004	*[Enter operational risk]*	*Operational*	—	—	—	*[Describe controls]*	*[Owner]*	OPEN	
COMPLIANCE & LEGAL RISKS									
CR-001	**Non-compliance with data privacy regulations (GDPR / CCPA)**	Compliance	3	4	12 MEDIUM	Privacy policy; DPA agreements; consent management	Legal/CTO	MONITORING	*Q1 2026*
CR-002	**IP infringement claim from competitor**	Compliance	2	4	8 MEDIUM	IP audit; freedom-to-operate review;	Legal/CEO	MONITORING	*Q2 2026*

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ID	Risk Title	Category	L (1-5)	I (1-5)	Score	Controls / Mitigations	Owner	Status	Review Date
						legal counsel retained			
CR-003	**Employment law non-compliance (contractor misclassification)**	Compliance	3	3	9 MEDIUM	HR review; employment counsel engaged; worker classification audit	HR/Legal	OPEN	*Q1 2026*
CR-004	*[Enter compliance risk]*	*Compliance*	—	—	—	*[Describe controls]*	*[Owner]*	OPEN	
TECHNOLOGY & CYBERSECURITY RISKS									
TR-001	**Data breach or cyberattack exposing customer PII**	Technology	3	5	15 HIGH	MFA enforced; penetration testing; incident response plan	CTO	MONITORING	*Q1 2026*
TR-002	**Critical dependency on a single cloud provider**	Technology	2	4	8 MEDIUM	Multi-region deployment; failover architecture documented	CTO	MONITORING	*Q2 2026*
TR-003	**Software supply chain attack via open-source dependency**	Technology	2	4	8 MEDIUM	SCA tools in CI/CD; dependency audit; SBOM maintained	CTO	OPEN	*Q2 2026*
TR-004	*[Enter technology risk]*	*Technology*	—	—	—	*[Describe controls]*	*[Owner]*	OPEN	
PEOPLE & TALENT RISKS									
PR-001	**Inability to attract / retain technical talent**	People	4	4	16 HIGH	Equity plan; competitive benchmarking; strong culture	CEO/HR	OPEN	*Q2 2026*
PR-002	**Toxic team dynamics or founder conflict**	People	2	5	10 MEDIUM	Founder agreement; leadership coaching; board involvement	Board/CEO	MONITORING	*Q2 2026*
PR-003	*[Enter people risk]*	*People*	—	—	—	*[Describe controls]*	*[Owner]*	OPEN	
REPUTATIONAL & MARKET RISKS									
RR-001	**Negative press, social media incident, or brand crisis**	Reputational	2	4	8 MEDIUM	PR playbook; media monitoring; crisis communication plan	CEO	MONITORING	*Q2 2026*
RR-002	*[Enter reputational risk]*	*Reputational*	—	—	—	*[Describe controls]*	*[Owner]*	OPEN	

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5 Risk Summary Dashboard

HIGH (15-25)	MEDIUM (8-14)	LOW (1-7)	TOTAL RISKS
____ risks	____ risks	____ risks	____ risks

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